

BAAZ & UDAY JKBOSE

2026 CLASS 11TH

We're Not Afraid to Die

LECTURE-03

ENGLISH

HUSSAIN SIR



Topics To Covered

- 1 “We’re Not Afraid to Die...if we Can All Be Together”
- 2 ... Explanation
- 3 ...
- 4 ...

“We’re Not Afraid to Die...
if we Can All Be Together”

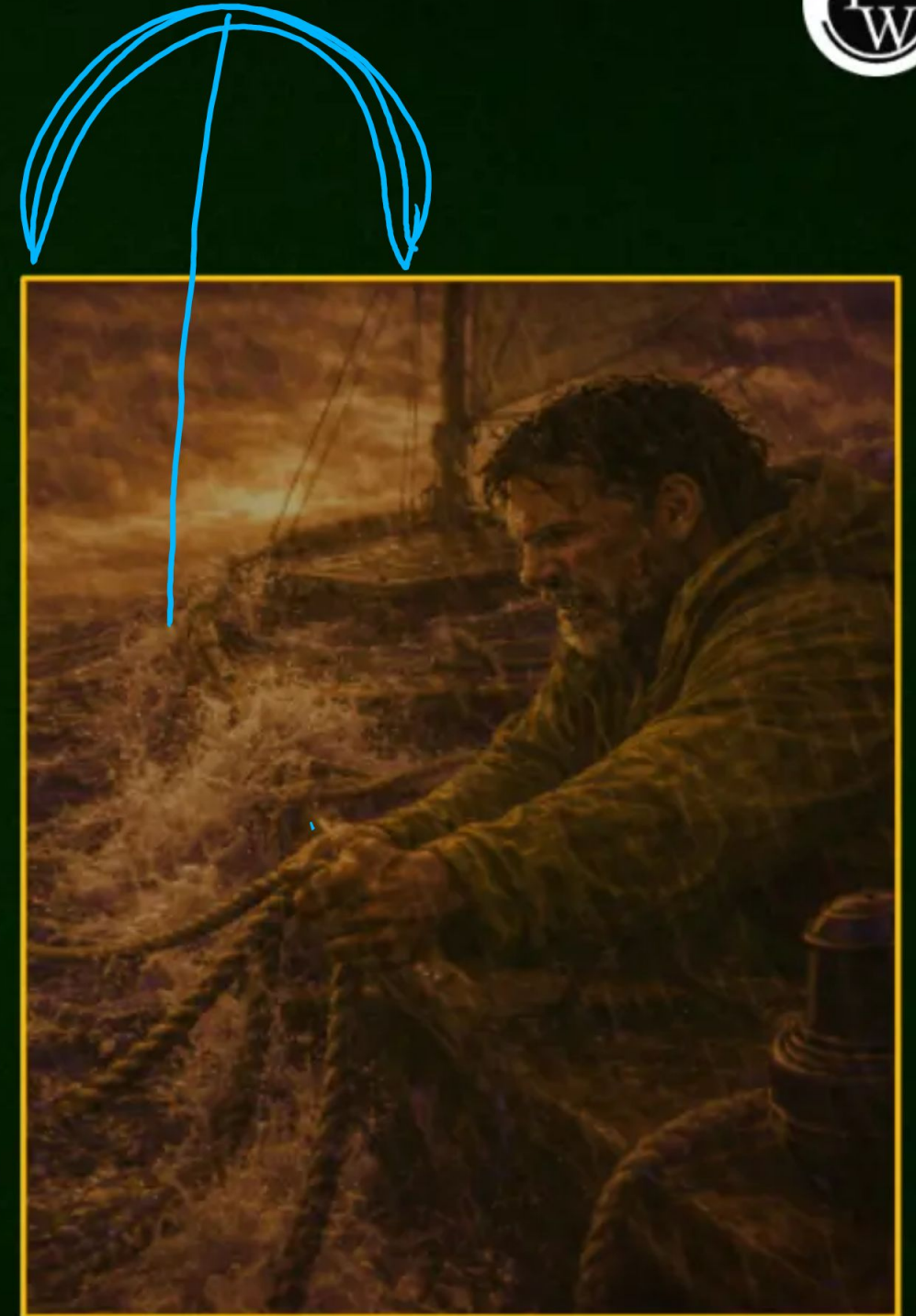
When I went in to comfort the children, Jon asked, “Daddy, are we going to die?” I tried to assure him that we could make it. “But, Daddy,” he went on, “we aren’t afraid of dying if we can all be together — you and Mummy, Sue and I.”



“We’re Not Afraid to Die...
if we Can All Be Together”

I could find no words with which to respond, but I left the children’s cabin determined to fight the sea with everything I had. To protect the weakened starboard side, I decided to heave to — with the undamaged port hull facing the oncoming waves, using an improvised sea anchor of heavy nylon rope and two 22 litre plastic barrels of paraffin.

heave to: slow down by adjusting its sails and helm to minimize forward motion



“We’re Not Afraid to Die... if we Can All Be Together”

That evening, Mary and I sat together holding hands, as the motion of the ship brought more and more water in through the broken planks. We both felt the end was very near.

But Wavewalker rode out the storm and by the morning of January 6, with the wind easing, I tried to get a reading on the sextant. Back in the chartroom, I worked on wind speeds, changes of course, drift and current in an effort to calculate our position. The best I could determine was that we were somewhere in 150,000 kilometres of ocean looking for a 65 kilometre-wide island.



“We’re Not Afraid to Die... if we Can All Be Together”

While I was thinking, Sue, moving painfully, joined me. The left side of her head was now very swollen and her blackened eyes narrowed to slits. She gave me a card she had made.

On the front she had drawn caricatures of Mary and me with the words: “Here are some funny people. Did they make you laugh? I laughed a lot as well.” Inside was a message: “Oh, how I love you both. So this card is to say thank you and let’s hope for the best.” Somehow we had to make it.



“We’re Not Afraid to Die...
if we Can All Be Together”

I checked and rechecked my calculations. We had lost our main compass and I was using a spare which had not been corrected for magnetic variation. I made an allowance for this and another estimate of the influence of the westerly currents which flow through this part of the Indian Ocean.

About 2 p.m., I went on deck and asked Larry to steer a course of 185 degrees. If we were lucky, I told him with a conviction I did not feel, he could expect to see the island at about 5 p.m.

conviction: determination



“We’re Not Afraid to Die...
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Then with a heavy heart, I went below, climbed on my bunk and amazingly, dozed off. When I woke it was 6 p.m., and growing dark. I knew we must have missed the island, and with the sail we had left, we couldn’t hope to beat back into the westerly winds.

At that moment, a tousled head appeared by my bunk. “Can I have a hug?” Jonathan asked. Sue was right behind him.

dozed off: went off to sleep

tousled head: disarranged hair



“We’re Not Afraid to Die...
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“Why am I getting a hug now?” I asked.

“Because you are the best daddy in the whole world – and the best captain,” my son replied.

“Not today, Jon, I’m afraid.”

“Why, you must be,” said Sue in a matter-of-fact voice. “You found the island.”

“What!” I shouted.

“It’s out there in front of us,” they chorused, “as big as a battleship.”



“We’re Not Afraid to Die...
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I rushed on deck and gazed with relief at the stark outline of Ile Amsterdam. It was only a bleak piece of volcanic rock, with little vegetation – the most beautiful island in the world!

We anchored offshore for the night, and the next morning all 28 inhabitants of the island cheered as they helped us ashore.

anchored: moored the ship to the sea bottom



“We’re Not Afraid to Die...
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With land under my feet again, my thoughts were full of Larry and Herbie, cheerful and optimistic under the direst stress, and of Mary, who stayed at the wheel for all those crucial hours.

Most of all, I thought of a seven-year-old girl, who did not want us to worry about a head injury (which subsequently took six minor operations to remove a recurring blood clot between skin and skull), and of a six-year-old boy who was not afraid to die.



QUESTION



What did the card say on the outside?

- A** “Here are some serious people.”
- B** “Here are some funny people. Did they make you laugh?”
- C** Stay safe.”
- D** “Good luck.”

QUESTION

How did the crew finally spot the island?

- A** By sound *f*
- B** By chance *f*
- C** By smell *f*
- D** By following compass readings and charts */*

QUESTION

How did the children describe the island when they saw it?

A "As big as a battleship" ✓

B "Tiny and far"

C "Barely visible"

D "Green and lush"

QUESTION

What quality of the children is highlighted in the chapter?

- ☐ A Laziness
- ☒ B Courage, optimism, and selflessness
- ☐ C Fear and panic
- ☒ D Courage, optimism, and selflessness

Thank
You